

I am the owner of parcel 0:0:111:114:1. If i were to grow fruit, would apple trees or kiwis be the better choice?



Terrain Expert



Based on the specific characteristics of your parcel and regional climate data, **apple trees** are currently the more reliable and culturally supported choice for your land in Asturias, though **kiwis** are also a viable commercial option in this region provided you manage water needs carefully.

Here is the detailed analysis:

1. Parcel Suitability (Asturias Context)

Your parcel is located in Asturias at a low altitude (39m) with gentle slopes (4.4%) and is currently pasture

`TOOL:territorio/get_plot` . The vegetation indices indicate healthy, moist soil conditions (NDVI mean ~0.82, NDWI mean ~0.38), which is favorable for fruit cultivation `TOOL:territorio/get_plot` .

2. Apple Trees (The Safer Bet)

- **Regional Fit:** Apples are deeply rooted in Asturian culture and agriculture. Research specifically targets apple cultivars suitable for northwestern Spain's mild winters `TD_AlvaroDelgadoDelgado-18-147.pdf` .
- **Climate Challenge:** The primary risk for apples in coastal/low-altitude Asturias (like your plot at 39m) is **insufficient winter chill**. High-chill varieties may fail to break dormancy as winters warm up `TD_AlvaroDelgadoDelgado-18-147.pdf` .
- **Recommendation:** You must select **low-chill cultivars**. Studies suggest that to maintain viability under future warming scenarios, farmers should either shift to higher elevations or, more practically for your fixed location, breed/select environmentally adapted cultivars with lower chilling requirements `TD_AlvaroDelgadoDelgado-18-147.pdf` . Given your plot's low elevation, selecting these specific varieties is critical.

3. Kiwi Fruit (High Potential, Higher Water Demand)

- **Regional Fit:** Asturias is actually one of the leading kiwi-producing regions in Europe due to its mild temperatures and lack of extreme frost, which kiwis dislike.
- **Water Requirement:** Kiwis have significantly higher water demands than apples. While your parcel shows good current humidity (NDWI > 0.38) `TOOL:territorio/get_plot` , kiwis generally require consistent irrigation and well-drained yet moist soil. Your parcel's "good natural drainage" noted in the terrain description `TOOL:territorio/get_plot` is positive, but you would likely need to install an irrigation system to sustain high-quality kiwi production during summer dry spells.
- **Infrastructure:** Unlike the scattered trees currently on your boundary, kiwis require a substantial trellis system (pergola style), representing a higher initial infrastructure investment compared to standard apple orchards.

Conclusion & Recommendation

- **Choose Apples if:** You want a lower-input crop that aligns with local tradition and available research support, *provided* you strictly select **low-chill varieties** suited for the 39m altitude `TD_AlvaroDelgadoDelgado-18-147.pdf` .
- **Choose Kiwis if:** You are willing to invest in irrigation infrastructure and trellising to capitalize on a high-value crop that thrives in the Asturian mild climate, leveraging your parcel's existing soil moisture `TOOL:territorio/get_plot` .

Given the explicit research focus on adapting apples to climate change in your exact region `TD_AlvaroDelgadoDelgado-18-147.pdf` , apples offer a more scientifically backed pathway for long-term sustainability on your specific plot without requiring major changes to water management infrastructure immediately.

`TOOL:territorio/get_plot` `TD_AlvaroDelgadoDelgado-18-147.pdf`